

Netherlands



Area 16,033 sq miles
(41,526 sq km)
Population 16.7 million
Capital Amsterdam
Currency Euro
Official language Dutch
Life expectancy 80 years



The Netherlands lies at the meeting point of four major rivers in northern Europe. The country's few hills, in the east and south, descend to a flat coastal area bordered by the North Sea to the north and the west. This is protected by dunes, dykes, and canals, since 27 percent of the coast is below sea level. The country became independent from Spain in 1648 and is a constitutional monarchy. Although the Netherlands' capital is Amsterdam, its government functions from the Hague. The country is a major trading hub, with Europe's biggest port, Rotterdam, located here. The Netherlands has a highly skilled and educated workforce and a tradition of high-tech innovation, including the development of the music cassette and CD. Multinational companies such as Philips and Shell are headquartered here.

◀ AMSTERDAM

The capital and the biggest city of the Netherlands, Amsterdam has a large canal system running through it. It is one of the most bicycle-friendly cities in the world.

Luxembourg



Area 998 sq miles
(2,586 sq km)
Population 500,000
Capital Luxembourg-Ville
Currency Euro
Official languages French, German, and Luxembourgish
Life expectancy 79 years



Luxembourg shares borders with Germany, France, and Belgium. It has the highest per capita income in the EU. It is also known as a banking center and is the headquarters of key EU institutions, such as the European Court of Justice.

Liechtenstein



Area 62 sq miles
(160 sq km)
Population 36,700
Capital Vaduz
Currency Swiss franc
Official language German
Life expectancy 80 years



This small, politically stable country is nestled in the Alps. Many overseas banks and investment companies operate here, and a third of its residents are foreign nationals. It has close ties with Switzerland, which handles its foreign relations and defense.



▲ MALBUN, LIECHTENSTEIN

The only ski resort in Liechtenstein, Malbun is a small mountain village located 5,200 ft (1,600 m) high in the Alps.